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a. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verbs in brackets and read the completed passage aloud.

The people of India, as a whole, 1 _____ (be) warm-hearted and hospitable. Any calamity in any part of the world immediately 2 _____ (arise) their charity and generosity and a committee 3 _____ (be) promptly 4 _____ (set) up to collect funds to help the distressed. The most endearing quality in them 5 _____ (be) the respect they show for the work done in any capacity. They 6 _____ (believe) in what we 7 _____ (call) the dignity of labour.

b. Now, use the verbs given in brackets in the following sentences in their correct forms.

1. I (like) to spend time with my friend, whenever I (be) free.

2. He (is) likely to miss the train. He (run) up to the station.

3. At the moment they (wait) at the bus-stop. But I (not know) their plans for the journey.

4. They firmly (believe) in the existence of God.

5. We (hear) a lot of noise because the new buildings (transmit) sound vacant.

6. She always (make) excuses for coming late.

7. The Prime Minister (leave) for America to meet the delegates tomorrow.

c. You are a commentator for a 5000 metre running race. Use simple present and present continuous tenses and complete the commentary from the beginning to the end of the race. Read the completed passage aloud.

The 5000 metre race is about to begin. Lined up at the starting point, from left to right, are John of Great Britain, Peter of Nigeria and Jeeva of India. The runners are warming up for the great event. Now they 1 _____ (take) their positions on the track. They 2 _____ (be) all ready for the start. There 3 _____ (go) the starter's gun! Yes, the race has begun. John 4 _____ (lead) with Jeeva 5 _____ (close) behind him.

d. Read the extract from Kayal's diary entry regarding her Nepal Trek, and fill in the blanks with the correct tense form of the verbs given in brackets.

DAY 1 We _____ (leave) Anna International Airport in Chennai two days ago catching a direct flight to Kathmandu in Nepal. We _____ (spend) a day sightseeing. Kathmandu is full of people, rickshaws and the smell of sandalwood. I've never _____ (be) on a trip like this before. So I'm really excited.

DAY 2 It _____ (rain) when we reached Pokhara, Nepal's second largest city, and saw the snowy peaks of the Himalayas for the first time. We _____(reach) Pokhara after a hair-raising six-hour bus journey along very narrow roads with a lot of hairpin bends. The bus _____ (be) so full that one person had to share the driver's seat.